

Is The World Ready For Howard Cosell Reruns?

CBS RADIO broadcaster Jack Buck, in a column by the Chicago Tribune's Gary Deeb, was quoted on his Monday night football TV competition: "I think Howard Cosell is about ready to run his course, like 'I Love Lucy' and 'The Honeymooners.'"

The only thing wrong for Jack, who does the Monday night games on radio with Hank Stram, is that Channel 11 in Los Angeles, which El Paso gets on the cable, still runs "I Love Lucy" every night at 7:30, including Monday.

Colorado State got some bad news but the University of Texas at El Paso received good news this week on injuries. UTEP defensive end Elroy Stoglin, injured on the Miners' defense first play against Arizona State last week, should be able to play Saturday against the Rams after first being ruled doubtful for the contest with stretched ligaments. The knee now appears only bruised.

CSU southpaw quarterback Steve Fairchild, who has started the Rams' last two games and ranks 24th nationally in total offense, sustained a bruise to his throwing shoulder last week in a 30-6 loss to Utah and will not start Saturday, but can play. Keith Lee, a junior college transfer like

Fairchild, will get his second start, having opened in the first game against Utah State. To show what a good athlete Lee is, he started at wide receiver for the Rams last week and caught one pass for 32 yards. Speedy Mark R. "Tinker" Bell, who missed last week's game at wide receiver, should be ready to go this week for the Rams.

CSU defensive tackle Mike Bell, compared by Miner head coach Bill Michael to former Oklahoma great Lee Roy Selmon, lists his hobbies as "hunting, jeeping, eating and girls." He and twin brother Mark E. Bell, CSU's starting tight end, are both the same height, but Mike spent the summer before his senior year in high school lifting weights and eating Ma Bell's good cooking, and gained about 30 pounds over his brother. Mike is now about 255, Mark about 235. UTEP guard Rod Miller will be blocking primarily on Bell, although Michael says, "We'll have to use more than one on him."

Michael was asked after last week's game at Arizona State by ex-baseball coach Andy Cohen, "How was your officiating, Bill?" Michael replied: "Their officiating wasn't worth a dime. Ours was all right." Michael



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was upset by two ASU fumbles whistled dead by the officials, but Michael said one official may have tried to balance things a bit by calling a Miner receiver in bounds on a sideline pass reception when his feet landed out of bounds.

THE TEMPERATURE in Phoenix last week was 104 degrees, a record for that date, and at game time in Tempe it was still about 90 degrees. "We had kids lose 12 or 15 pounds," Michael said. "We stood the heat pretty good, though." Michael said only two players got cramps — offensive tackle Marshall Gordon and safety Eddie Forkerway, but both returned. UTEP's showing in the second half is further testimony to UTEP's conditioning program.

Michael was asked by the Miners use so many audibles on offense: "The reason we use audibles is that we're usually not as big man for man and we couldn't move offensively unless we let our quarterbacks change the play at the line of scrimmage if they see a weakness in the defense."

The Miners' head coach says that junior quarterback Jay Birkhead "did a good job of picking audibles" against ASU. "He's got a good head on his shoulders," Michael says Birk-

head can't throw the long pass as well as veteran quarterback Oscar Ramirez, but adds: "Jay is good on the short ones and on the rollouts. The things he can do well we've got to let him do, and not make him do things he can't." CSE was hurt by the scrambling of Brigham Young's Jim McMahon two weeks ago in a 32-6 defeat, and both Ramirez and Birkhead are good scramblers.

Speaking of Reggie Jackson, which nearly everybody is, the Yankees' glamour boy was once a defensive back at Arizona State, where he starred in baseball before signing with Kansas City as a sophomore in 1965. It sounds strange, but Moon Mullins, ASU sports information director, says: "The thing you remember about him was his hustle. And he had the shortest hair cut I believe I've ever seen."

The Miners' coaches who played or coached at the University of Oklahoma probably won't be able to keep up with the OU-Texas game Saturday, but for the record: OU was 2-4 against the Longhorns when Michael was assistant coach with OU from 1967 to 1972; OU didn't lose to UT when Miner assistant head coach Dick Gwinn played for OU in the mid-1950s; OU was 2-0 the two years secondary coach Durwood Keeton played and OU was 0-2 when recruiting coordinator and linebacker coach Robert McElroy was at Norman in '67-'68.

OU'S TEAM is more predominantly Texas this year than usual, which evokes the oft-quoted comment which

first appeared in a Sports Illustrated article by Dan Jenkins before the '63 Dallas bash. Texas fullback Harold Phillip of Olney was quoted as saying: "A Texas boy playing for Oklahoma is like an American fighting for Nazi Germany." OU even the score, however: UT offensive coordinator Bobby Warmack starred for OU at quarterback from '66 to '68.

BYU, already 2-0, can win the WAC title without leaving Utah. UTEP visits Provo Oct. 21 and Wyoming and San Diego State must also go to BYU. BYU's only road game is at Utah

The report on El Paso Parkland-ex Mike Williams: New Mexico's fullback gained only 47 yards on 15 carries against BYU in the 27-23 loss, his lowest total since his sophomore season.

Notre Dame center Dave Huffman, from Dallas, on why he went to school out of state: "I thought I owed it to myself to go out of state instead of going where everybody I'd meet would be from EL Paso or Sweetwater or Magnolia Tree or Frogs Knot or whatever. So I thought I was coming to the big city — and I got South Bend."



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